

Initio

Brand Identity Requirements

This document defines the complete visual and verbal identity system for Initio — a timeless brand built on heritage, clarity, and refined elegance. For use by designers, vendors, and brand partners.

Heritage Timeless design principles that build trust and credibility.	Clarity Clean, structured communication at every touchpoint.	Elegance Refined aesthetics that elevate the brand above the ordinary.
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COLOR PALETTE

Cetacean Blue #010F24	Asro Blue #71B8E3	Ocean Blue #2D64AE	Cadet #596A72	Light Gray #D4D4D4
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01 Color Palette

The Initio palette is built around a deep blue spectrum — anchored by Cetacean Blue and accented with lighter, energetic tones. Every color has a defined role and must be used consistently across all touchpoints.

	NAME	ROLE	HEX	RGB	CMYK
	Cetacean Blue	Primary / Background	#010F24	1, 15, 36	96, 58, 0, 91
	Asro Blue	Accent / Highlight	#71B8E3	113, 184, 227	50, 19, 0, 11
	Ocean Blue	Secondary / CTA	#2D64AE	45, 100, 174	74, 43, 0, 32
	Cadet	Neutral / Body Text	#596A72	89, 106, 114	22, 7, 0, 55
	Light Gray	Background / Dividers	#D4D4D4	212, 212, 212	0, 0, 0, 17

Color Harmony: The primary pairing is Cetacean Blue + Asro Blue. Ocean Blue serves as the action color for CTAs and links only.

02 Typography

Initio uses a dual-typeface system that pairs classical authority with modern legibility. Each typeface occupies a distinct role and must not be substituted.

PRIMARY TYPEFACE Garamond A classical serif with timeless elegance. Chosen for its heritage character, subtle stroke contrast, and strong readability in both print and digital contexts. Use for: Headlines, display text, brand statements, editorial titles	SECONDARY TYPEFACE Montserrat A modern geometric sans-serif offering clean contemporary contrast to Garamond. High legibility at small sizes, ideal for structured UI contexts. Use for: Body copy, UI elements, navigation labels, captions, event content
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Type Hierarchy

LEVEL	TYPEFACE	SIZE	WEIGHT	USE
H1 — Display	EB Garamond	48–64 pt	Regular / SemiBold	Hero headlines, cover titles
H2 — Heading	EB Garamond	28–36 pt	Regular	Section titles, page headers

H3 — Subheading	Montserrat	16–20 pt	SemiBold	Sub-sections, card titles
Body	Montserrat	9–11 pt	Regular	Paragraphs, descriptions
Caption / Label	Montserrat	7–8.5 pt	Medium / Bold	Captions, tags, metadata

03 Iconography & Imagery Style

The visual language of Initio is editorial, data-forward, and minimal. These guidelines apply to all brand materials including digital assets, print, and event production.

DIMENSION	DIRECTION
Illustration Style	Minimal, line-based or flat vector. No gradients in icons. Use single-color or dual-tone (Cetacean + Asro) compositions.
Icon Weight	Consistent stroke width. Prefer 1.5–2px equivalent strokes at standard scale. Avoid filled icons unless used as UI indicators.
Photography Mood	Editorial and data-forward. Dark-background mockups for digital. Cool-toned, high-contrast imagery. Avoid warm filters or over-saturated photography.
Graphic Elements	Horizontal gradient bars (Cetacean to Asro Blue) for section dividers or accents. Geometric shapes only — no organic forms.
Data Visualization	Charts follow the brand palette. Primary axis: Asro Blue. Supporting data: Ocean Blue and Cadet. Grid lines in Light Gray.

04 Brand Voice

Initio communicates with authority and warmth — never cold, never casual. The brand voice reflects five core attributes across all written touchpoints: website copy, event communications, proposals, and social content.

ATTRIBUTE	HOW IT SOUNDS
CREDIBLE	Speaks with evidence and precision. Avoids hyperbole — lets results and data do the talking.
SOPHISTICATED	Refined vocabulary and structured sentences. Elevates tone above the ordinary without becoming inaccessible.
TIMELESS	Rooted in lasting design principles. Avoids trend-chasing language. Every word should age well.
CLEAR	Direct and structured. No jargon, no filler. Communication resonates at the first read.
MODERN	Forward-looking and adaptive. Approachable without sacrificing authority. Engages both traditional and contemporary audiences.

05 Brand Personality & Tone of Voice

Initio's personality is the human expression of the brand — how it thinks, speaks, and presents itself across every interaction. The following traits and tone guidelines apply to all written and verbal communication.

Brand Personality Traits

TRAIT	DESCRIPTION
Heritage-Driven	We draw from timeless principles. Our communication feels established, not trendy — grounded in craft and built to last.
Authoritative	We speak as experts. Confident without arrogance. Our tone reflects deep knowledge and earns trust through substance.
Sophisticated	We elevate the conversation. Refined vocabulary, considered structure, and precision in every word — never casual, never loud.
Approachable	Despite our authority, we remain human. We speak clearly, avoid jargon, and welcome dialogue without compromising our standards.
Forward-Thinking	We look ahead. Our tone reflects ambition and vision — optimistic about progress, grounded in strategy.

Tone of Voice Guidelines

Tone shifts slightly depending on context — more formal in proposals, slightly warmer in social. However, the core personality never changes. These dimensions guide every writing decision.

DIMENSION	GUIDANCE
Formal vs. Casual	Formal — structured sentences, complete thoughts. Not stiff or bureaucratic, but never colloquial or slang-driven.
Active vs. Passive	Always active voice. 'We deliver results' not 'Results are delivered by us.' Directness signals confidence.
Short vs. Long Copy	Concise by default. Every sentence earns its place. Long-form content is permitted when depth is required, never for padding.
Emotional vs. Rational	Primarily rational — we lead with evidence, data, and structure. Emotion is present in aspiration and vision, never in hype.
Inclusive Language	Gender-neutral, globally aware. Avoid regional idioms that may not translate. Clarity over cleverness.

Writing Examples

Use these examples as a reference when producing copy for any Initio touchpoint.

WRITING EXAMPLE	
✓ Write this	<i>Initio transforms brand strategy into measurable outcomes — through clarity, design, and precision execution.</i>
✗ Not this	<i>We're super excited to offer you amazing branding solutions that will totally change your business!</i>
✓ Write this	<i>Our team delivers integrated campaigns built on audience insight, creative rigor, and performance data.</i>
✗ Not this	<i>Check out our awesome team — they're the best at making really cool campaigns that get results!!</i>

06 Usage Rules — Dos & Don'ts

These rules protect the integrity of the Initio brand. All designers, vendors, and partners must adhere to these guidelines before producing any branded material.

✓ DO	✗ DON'T
Use Cetacean Blue (#010f24) as the primary background on dark layouts	Do not use Cadet on Cetacean Blue — insufficient contrast
Pair Garamond headlines with Montserrat body text	Do not use Garamond for body text below 11pt — use Montserrat
Use Asro Blue as the accent/highlight on both light and dark backgrounds	Do not introduce colors outside the defined palette
Maintain clear space around the logo equal to the cap-height of the wordmark	Do not place the logo on busy photographic backgrounds without a dark overlay
Use Ocean Blue exclusively for CTAs and interactive elements	Do not use warm-toned or high-saturation photography
Apply Light Gray (#d4d4d4) for dividers, borders, and secondary backgrounds	Do not use Ocean Blue as a background — it is a CTA/action color only
Use cool-toned, high-contrast photography	Do not stretch, rotate, recolor, or add effects to the logo
Ensure all text on dark backgrounds uses white or Light Gray only	Do not use decorative or display fonts as alternatives to Garamond or Montserrat

Background Usage: Dark layouts must use Cetacean Blue (#010f24) as the sole background. Light layouts use white or Light Gray (#d4d4d4). Never use Ocean Blue or Asro Blue as full-page backgrounds.

Approved Combinations: Cetacean + White text | Cetacean + Asro Blue accents | White + Cetacean text | Light Gray + Cetacean text | Ocean Blue + White text (CTAs only)